FINANCIAL TRANSPARENCY COALITION

STRATEGY 2026–2030

Ending the era of secrecy

Public access to ownership and tax data is not a side product of transparency. It is the condition for ending illicit financial flows.

Financial Transparency Coalition · Secretariat hosted by LATINDADD, Lima, Peru

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ABOUT THE FTC

Founded in 2009, the Financial Transparency Coalition is a coalition of eleven organisations across four continents working to end illicit financial flows and to build a financial system that enables human rights, environmental justice and gender justice.

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IMPRINT

Financial Transparency Coalition
c/o LATINDADD, Jr Mariscal Miller 2622
Lince, Lima 15073, Peru

www.financialtransparency.org
info@financialtransparency.org

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FOREWORD

A strategic response to the global economic and financial crisis

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policy asks in the Global Charter, from automatic exchange of information to a Global Asset Registry

The global financial and economic system carries a crisis of austerity and rising inequality of wealth and income, coupled with ecological breakdown driven by the illicit overexploitation of fisheries, forests, minerals and land — and with forced labour still commonplace in the sectors that supply it.

Add rising conflict and human rights abuses, and the pattern becomes clear: power and resources are being abused for military gain while dark financing erodes democratic institutions, inside economic and financial systems that were never designed to halt illicit financial flows. Global South countries absorb the consequences first, and within them women, girls and marginalised communities absorb them hardest.

These dynamics are not gender-neutral. Women and girls disproportionately carry the impacts of fiscal austerity, cuts to public services and underinvestment in care. Climate and environmental crises fall on the communities with the least economic and political power. Financial secrecy reinforces both, by limiting public accountability and constraining the resources needed for any transformative response.

This strategy presents an updated set of policy asks — the ABC-DEFG of Financial Transparency, which we put forward as a Global Charter for Financial Transparency for states, regional bodies and international institutions to adopt, and for civil society, academia and other stakeholders to promote. It updates the earlier ABC of Financial Transparency, an agenda that is advancing in many places but still lacks the element that makes it work: public access to ownership and tax data.

> Public access is not an add-on. Without public scrutiny, there will be no end to illicit financial flows.

Public access is essential so that civil society, journalists and academics can do their work: analysing tax trends and ownership structures, and holding states, companies and wealthy individuals to account. That means data on the assets that make up wealth and generate high incomes, tax data showing what large companies actually pay, and the beneficial owners of all companies and legal vehicles.

There are many uses for public financial transparency. In this strategic period we focus on three intertwined crises, set out alongside.

The overarching goal of the 2026–2030 strategy is twofold: to make the findings and the uses of financial transparency accessible to everyone, and to mobilise in a cross-movement strategy that turns that data and knowledge into people power — against austerity, the concentration of power, environmental destruction and human rights violations.

We look forward to working with our members, partners and allies to end the era of secrecy for good, and to use public knowledge of how the global financial system works to help resolve some of the greatest challenges of our time.

Matti Kohonen
Executive Director, Financial Transparency Coalition

THREE INTERTWINED CRISES

Care. A crisis of care and social security that should be funded by taxing wealth, corporations, extractive industries and high incomes.

Nature. Illicit fisheries, forestry and critical mineral mining that threaten ecosystems, obstruct climate action and cause human rights violations.

Multilateralism. Oligarchic and ultra-wealthy interests buying elected representatives to erode international co-operation and democracy.

The context we are in

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crises this strategy addresses through transparency: care, natural resources and multilateralism

We live in an era of rising inequality of wealth and income, deepening gender inequality and the marginalisation of minority groups, inside a global economy geared towards extracting wealth from Global South countries and accumulating it among Global North elites and large corporations. Illegal wars and invasions are committed by major powers whose perpetrators act with impunity, feeding the crisis of multilateralism.

Earlier shocks have not been absorbed. Countries borrowed through the pandemic into a debt crisis that has since worsened, while rising military spending strains every other line of public expenditure. Recovery policies were poorly targeted and opaque: almost nowhere were the beneficial owners behind emergency procurement checked.

This is also an era of ecosystem breakdown, accelerated by the opacity of corporate structures in fisheries, forestry, mining, oil and gas — industries that neither pay their fair share of taxes nor pay for the harm they cause. A low-carbon transition requires transparency in climate-related flows, subsidies, ownership and extractive investment.

Oligarchy now threatens democratic decision-making itself: economies dominated by a small group of the super-wealthy and large corporations that have captured political systems — in the Global North, where economic governance is legislated largely in their favour, and in the Global South, where elite networks assist the same extraction.

The demand for change comes from civil society, journalists and social movements — the actors facing anti-protest laws, press restrictions and corporate courts used to silence those who name the responsibility of companies and wealthy individuals. Their agency is taken away with the help of enablers in law, banking and accounting.

We cannot build a democratic, rights-based international system without knowing who owns what and where, and what — if anything — corporations and the ultra-rich pay in tax.

THE ABC-DEFG OF FINANCIAL TRANSPARENCY

The Global Charter for Financial Transparency

Financial secrecy is a structural driver of inequality, tax abuse, environmental destruction, corruption and democratic erosion. It keeps wealth, assets and corporate activity hidden from public scrutiny and reduces the capacity of states to fund public services, social protection, care systems and climate action — most severely in Global South countries. This Charter is our statement of the policy proposals that would end it.

A **Automatic exchange of information** (AEOI) for tax purposes is the key to ending offshore secrecy of wealth held in other countries and jurisdictions, including in secrecy jurisdictions.

B **Beneficial owners.** Public registries of beneficial owners, to allow the taxation of wealth in all its forms and to end the impunity of the people behind human rights violations, environmental crimes, illicit financial flows and tax abuse.

C **Country-by-country reporting.** Public reporting to enable the collection of corporate taxes and an eventual move to unitary taxation, where each company is taxed as a single entity and taxing rights are distributed equitably — including through the UN Framework Convention on International Tax Cooperation and the Compromiso de Sevilla.

D **Data access and whistleblower protection.** Public access to corporate and asset data — annual accounts, company filings, subsidiary accounts, tax incentives and other subsidies, court records, fines and sanctions — together with strong protection for those who expose illicit, unethical or unsafe practices, as in the Panama Papers, LuxLeaks and SwissLeaks.

ADOPT AND PROMOTE

We call on states, regional bodies and international institutions to adopt the Charter, and on civil society, academia and other stakeholders to promote it.

E **Enabler professionals.** Regulation requiring public disclosure of tax advice schemes and their automatic exchange across borders; anti-money-laundering law covering a wide set of assets and a comprehensive list of professions; public registries of enablers; and public access to the sanctions and fines imposed on companies, their beneficial owners and their advisers.

F **Finance industry transparency.** We need the legal and beneficial owners of entities held privately or through investment vehicles: private equity, private credit, hedge funds, non-bank lenders, insurance wrappers, real-estate investment trusts and public-private partnership contracts. These vehicles own housing, care homes, nurseries, public transport and other infrastructure.

G **Global Asset Registry.** Global rules to declare the legal and beneficial owners of high-value and high-risk assets: vessels, vehicles, aircraft, real estate, land, precious metals, art and antiquities, forestry, fishing and mining rights, and digital assets.

NOT A SILVER BULLET

A beneficial ownership registry, an asset declaration or corporate tax reporting does not deliver change on its own. Transparency has to be followed by policy: taxing ultra-wealthy people, sanctioning the owners behind environmental crimes, and taxing large multinationals as single unitary entities.

> Illicit financial flows are not a big number. They are a package of reforms — and the Charter is the road map.

Building knowledge to build people's power

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countries, primarily in the Global South, where members will carry the projects into national policy

System change requires a cross-movement approach. The role of the FTC and its members is to bring the lens of financial transparency to the issues other movements are already fighting on, and to apply their analysis to ours. We do this in three ways: producing knowledge that documents and exposes tax abuse and illicit financial flows; sharing that knowledge and elevating the knowledge of other networks; and engaging in advocacy in global spaces while enabling our members' advocacy at regional and national level.

Transparency is not a silver bullet. It has to be used to shift policy debates — on financing public services, on ending the illicit exploitation of minerals, forests, land and oceans — and, at a normative level, to build a human rights-based economy.

THREE POLICY AND ADVOCACY PROJECTS, 2026–2030

PEOPLE'S FISCAL MONITOR

Monitoring how financial transparency enables the taxation of wealth, high incomes, large corporations and extractive industries to finance care systems and social protection in the Global South, and aligning that monitoring with like-minded groups in the Global North.

FINANCIAL SECRETS OF NATURAL RESOURCES

Monitoring illicit financial flows linked to fisheries, forestry, mining and commercial agriculture, including forced labour, and building the case for public disclosure of the beneficial ownership and assets behind them.

HUMAN RIGHTS-BASED GLOBAL ECONOMY

Monitoring global economic policy and governance debates from a rights-based perspective, to build the basis for economic and financial alternatives not driven by profit, growth or extractivism.

Each project monitors global governance bodies while carrying policy advice through our members into between ten and fifteen countries, primarily in the Global South.

Working across movements

Our work is not limited to FTC's membership. Through social movements, civil society groups and trade unions we build people power grounded in knowledge of who owns what, how wealth accumulates, how companies are structured and how global financial flows operate. In this strategic period we work with:

1. **Anti-austerity movements** demanding an end to IFI pressure for austerity, and alternatives that finance public services through progressive taxation.
2. **Feminist and human rights organisations** demanding the right to care and social protection, and linking feminist tax and financial reform to this agenda.
3. **Environmental justice and anti-extractive movements** seeking an end to illicit fisheries, forestry and mining, which requires full disclosure of the ownership structures behind unlawful extraction and tax abuse.
4. **Transport and maritime trade unions** working to protect fishers' rights and the rights of other workers in the maritime sector.
5. **New economy movements** shifting the discourse from neoliberal, growth-based policy towards rights-based, decolonial, feminist and post-extractivist economies.

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member organisations across Africa, Asia, Europe and Latin America

Our theory of change

1 The Charter and its seven points are a set of reforms and a road map against illicit financial flows as a root cause of hidden assets, profit shifting, tax abuse, political capture and environmental crime.

2 The Charter's change goals are made relevant to social movements, civil society, trade unions and community organisations, who recognise them as a way to stop IFFs and to advance their own struggles.

3 IFFs are treated as a package, not a headline number: a registry or a tax disclosure changes little unless it is followed by taxing wealth, sanctioning owners behind environmental crime, and unitary taxation.

4 FTC distributes power by widening access to data and method: tools and training to interpret public data, shared access to closed databases, and communities of practice that use them for policy change.

5 FTC maps the moments, pressure points and windows of opportunity where timely analysis can convert into effective change.

6 FTC builds the narrative of a Rights-Based Economy: a feminist, decolonial, anti-racist political economy that is both a lens on other proposals and a proposition in itself.

7 FTC shares findings, builds alliances and advocacy agendas, and shows the contribution of financial transparency to ending multiple crises.

8 FTC celebrates victories, however big or small, in our field and in related ones, building the confidence that reinforces the next round of change.

THE CHAIN

Knowledge → shared method → cross-movement mobilisation → policy change → resources for care, nature and democracy.

Fifteen years of momentum

The Charter did not appear from nowhere. It is the accumulation of policy change our members have built across regions since 2009.

2009

founded as the Task Force on Financial Integrity and Economic Development

TABLE 1 · BUILDING MOMENTUM ON IFFS AND POLICY CHANGE, 2009–2025

Period / region	Milestone
2009	Founded as the Task Force on Financial Integrity and Economic Development; helped secure the inclusion of illicit financial flows in the 2030 Agenda and convened a partnership panel of governments including Norway, France, Germany and Chile.
2013	Became a CSO coalition and defined its change goals as the ABC of Financial Transparency, drawing on members' work on information exchange, public country-by-country reporting and beneficial ownership.
2013–2017	Expanded into a Global South-led South–North coalition, with members joining from Latin America, Africa, Asia and Europe.
Latin America and the Caribbean	LATINDADD built progressive tax systems to finance public services, convening regional tax authorities and parliamentarians; Fundación SES, and CEFILAT from 2026, worked with financial intelligence units on public beneficial ownership registries.
Africa	Tax Justice Network Africa and PALU, within the Stop the Bleeding Campaign, advocate a wide definition of IFFs; FTC seed-funded the Anti-IFF Tracker of commitments made under the 2015 Mbeki Panel report and the SDGs.
Asia	CBGA works on how financial secrecy harms progressive revenue mobilisation; APMDD studies transparency in the taxation of wealthy individuals and convenes the Asia Finance Summit.
Europe	EURODAD and Transparency International led on the Anti-Money Laundering Directive, which in 2020 set a precedent for public registries before the 2022 Court of Justice ruling; work continues to restore full public access. Christian Aid and Global Witness advocated the UK's public register.
United States	GFI advocated the Corporate Transparency Act; the FTC-funded report *Acres of Money Laundering* was cited in the bill that created the US beneficial ownership registry.
2020–2021	Co-created the End Austerity Campaign, analysing COVID-19 recovery spending in first nine and then twenty-one Global South countries.
2021–	Works with fisheries CSOs and trade unions to uncover the companies and beneficial owners behind illegal, unreported and unregulated fishing and forced labour at sea.

Source: FTC secretariat. Full history at www.financialtransparency.org

Our governance structure

For this strategic period the coalition is hosted by a Global South member, LATINDADD, based in Peru. Most secretariat staff will be based in Latin America and the Caribbean, while the Executive Director role can be contracted from anywhere.

Every member appoints a representative to the Coordination Committee; two members at a time serve on the Executive Committee, which oversees the operations of the global secretariat. From 2025 we have been assembling a board of scientific advisors drawn from academia and experienced practitioners, to be expanded so that each project and the secretariat receive expert input.

The coalition will open to new members joining the Coordination Committee, and to a wider set of allied organisations. Organisations can move between the two: an applicant approved by the Coordination Committee is invited into the working groups, and can apply separately to join the Committee itself, which must remain regionally and thematically balanced.

SECRETARIAT

1.5 people at the start of 2026, to grow to no more than 4 FTE: Executive Director (100%), Finance and Operations Officer (50%), Communications Officer (vacant), Media and Investigations Officer (project-funded). Each working group has a coordinator contracted for the purpose.

FIGURE 1 · GOVERNANCE AND WORKING GROUPS



Measuring impact

We measure the strategy along a single chain, from the resources of the coalition to the use cases of financial transparency in specific fields and sectors. Change goals are the measurable policy changes in the middle of that chain.

TABLE 2 · RESULTS CHAIN, 2026–2030

Inputs	Activities	Outputs	Outcomes	Impacts
Our people, our coalition, our data, systems and resources	Coalition and movement building, research, advocacy, dissemination	Aimed at the wider public, policy makers, governments, civil society, journalists and researchers	Our change goals: advancing and monitoring the ABC-DEFG as measurable policy change	Use cases of the ABC-DEFG in thematic fields, topics and sectors
Global coalition, secretariat staff and systems Fundraised income Quantitative and qualitative data collected	Joint positions Joint research efforts Policy and advocacy events Movement and field building Research methodology and coordination Research writing Fundraising	People's Fiscal Monitor Financial Secrets of the Forests Financial Secrets of Fisheries Rights-Based Economy Advocacy at the UN Tax Convention Advocacy at the UN FfD process Advocacy at the World Bank and IMF Webinars, blogs and dissemination	Automatic exchange of tax information Public beneficial ownership registries Public country-by-country reporting Data access and whistleblower protection Enabler regulation Finance industry transparency Global Asset Registry	People's Fiscal Monitor measures how progressive taxation funds care and social protection Financial Secrets of Fisheries, Forests and Natural Resources measures the impact of secrecy on environmental crime and human rights abuse Rights-Based Economy measures shifts in the global financial architecture

Source: FTC monitoring, evaluation and learning framework, 2026.

Timeline 2026–2030

The moments where transparency asks can convert into binding commitments, and where we will concentrate advocacy.

2026

UN Tax Convention: secure ambitious language on public disclosure of key financial transparency measures.

Recognise illicit fishing and illicit deforestation as environmental crimes and as key sources of illicit financial flows in the relevant frameworks.

Build alternatives to austerity in progressive taxation, ahead of the World Bank and IMF Annual Meetings in Bangkok.

2027

UN Tax Convention: hold ambition on illicit financial flows and financial transparency.

Work with fisheries and forestry movements and national organisations on public transparency and accountability against environmental crime.

Work at UNODC to classify illicit fishing and deforestation as environmental crimes, and increase the number of implementing countries.

Collaborate with anti-austerity movements at the IMF and World Bank meetings; launch a book on alternatives to austerity.

2028

Support ratification of the UN Tax Convention and the protocols implementing financial transparency, progressive taxation and the definition of illicit financial flows.

Launch a Rights-Based Economy Alliance at IAFFE or another suitable conference.

Prepare for the renewal of SDG indicator 16.4.1 on illicit financial flows, and an index ranking enabler professionals and companies.

2029–2030

Ratification of the UN Tax Convention and its protocols; participation in the COP.

Participate in the UN beyond-SDG Summit with a focus on SDG 16.

Assess progress across the strategic period and build the next strategy.

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Ending the era of secrecy, for once and for good.

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